2 Dave is 4 years older than Colin.
Ruth is three times as old as Dave.

The total of their three ages is 56

Work out Ruth's age.

Colin = c; Dave = c + 4; Ruth = 3(c + 4)

1 mark
Express the linked ages using one letter.

c + (c + 4) + 3(c + 4) = 56

1 mark
Their sum is 56.

5c + 16 = 56

5c = 40, so c = 8

1 mark
Solve for Colin.

Ruth = 3(8 + 4) = 36 years

1 mark
Ruth's age is required, not Colin's.

36

(Total for Question 2 is 4 marks)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA
DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA